Unit 1. Introducing BUILD (Reflection)

Overview

Welcome to the first Module of the BUILD course – *2 Timothy & the Pastoral Epistles: Preaching the Gospel & Godly Leadership*. This unit will introduce you to BUILD and help you to catch its vision for *'Building leaders, building churches, building the kingdom'*. It will also help you to understand the BUILD course you are beginning and the BUILD programme you are a part of.

Outline

- BUILD's logo
- BUILD's aim and anchor verse
- The five words that BUILD stands for
- The five challenges we face as leaders
- BUILD's vision, mission and values
- The structure of a BUILD programme
- Introducing the BUILD course
- Conclusion

Outcomes

By the end of the unit you will be able to

1. Explain the importance of BUILD to another church leader
2. Make an informed commitment to continuing with BUILD learning
3. Recall a verse that expresses what BUILD stands for
4. Demonstrate an awareness of the challenges you face in your ministry
5. List and describe the key features of the BUILD curriculum

1.1 BUILD'S LOGO

A logo is a picture or symbol that communicates what something stands for. BUILD's logo will help us to see what BUILD stands for.

- Look at the BUILD logo below and discuss the questions that follow.

- When you look at the picture above, what things do you see?

- What do you think these mean and what might they tell us about BUILD, and about a good church?

- Think about your church. To what extent does it display these marks or fail to?

In looking at BUILD's logo we have seen some of the things that are important to BUILD:

- The centrality of God's gospel;
- The foundation of God's word;
- The presence of God's Holy Spirit;
- The value of God's people;
- The priority of God's mission;
- The importance of godly leaders who encourage all of the above.

1.2 BUILD'S AIM AND ANCHOR VERSE

The word BUILD sums up **the aim of the BUILD programme**, which is:

"To BUILD God's Church through helping to grow and multiply healthy local churches."

Everything else about the programme serves that purpose. Keeping God's true gospel central; building on the foundation of God's word; welcoming the presence of his Holy Spirit; loving God's people; prioritising his mission; training local leaders to facilitate this.

Our ambition to build God's Church is endorsed by **the BUILD anchor verse**, Matthew 16:18. There Jesus says:

> "I will BUILD my church"

That is the key phrase, but learn the whole verse:

> "And I tell you that you are Peter,
> and on this rock I will build my church,
> and the gates of Hades will not overcome it."

Peter was the first disciple to recognise and proclaim that Jesus is the Christ "the Messiah, the Son of the living God" (Matt 18:16). Christ's church is built on the witness of the apostles and the good news that they proclaimed.

God's church will grow because Jesus himself has promised to build it. He will nurture and protect it until it is firm and steadfast. In Module One we will see that those first leaders passed on the baton to others, who passed the message on to others… and it has now reached us (2 Tim 2:2).

In Christ's strength, with the same gospel, and motivated by his promise our job is to make sure that chain of witness and growth continues. We can be confident that Jesus will use us as builders in his great building project.

This means it is a great privilege to serve as a local church worker or church leader, whether as a volunteer, or part-time, or full-time. It is one of the greatest privileges on earth. BUILD will help us to become better builders with Christ and for him.

1.3 THE FIVE WORDS THAT BUILD STANDS FOR

Not only does the name BUILD have a meaning, but each letter in that name begins a word that is important to BUILD. For example, B stands for Biblical.

Those five words have been linked to five verses from 2 Timothy in the presentation below. This will help us to learn about the programme and its values. And 2 Timothy is the first book the BUILD course looks at; these verses will help introduce that book.

- Look at the letters, learn the words they stand for, and find the verses in your Bible and read them out loud.
- Why do you think these verses have been chosen? Explain the link between the word (e.g. Biblical) and the verse (e.g. 2 Tim 3:16-17).
- What do the words and Bible verses tell us about the training of local church leaders and about BUILD?
- Write your answers in the spaces between each letter, word and scripture below.

B is for **Biblical…**	2 Tim 3:16-17	**"Scripture..."**
U is for **Understanding…**	2 Tim 2:15	**"Handles..."**
I is for **In-service…**	2 Tim 2:7	**"Reflect..."**
L is for **Leadership…**	2 Tim 2:2	**"Entrust..."**
D is for **Development…**	2 Tim 3:14	**"Continue..."**

In summary, the name 'BUILD' stands for:

'Biblical Understanding for In-service Leadership Development'

1.4 THE FIVE CHALLENGES WE FACE AS LEADERS

Following on from the above we can underline the importance of BUILD in terms of five challenges we face in local church leadership:

1. Biblical – "All Scripture..."

The challenge of keeping the Bible central.

2. Understanding – "Correctly handles..."

The challenge of explaining and applying the teaching of the Bible

3. In-service – "Reflect..."

The challenge of remaining committed to mission.

4. Leadership – "Entrust..."

The challenge of a lack of faithful leaders who can train others.

5. Development – "Continue..."

The challenge of persevering with gospel ministry.

- In what ways do the challenges listed above affect you?

- How can we begin to overcome these challenges together?

BUILD aims to meet these challenges and it has a set of resources that we will keep returning to. Those resources include all the above. But they also include BUILD's **vision**, **mission** and **values**, together with the **structure** of every BUILD programme.

1.5 BUILD'S VISION, MISSION AND VALUES

We have already discovered BUILD's **aim**, which is to build God's Church through growing and multiplying healthy local churches.

It is also important for any ministry or project to have a clear **vision**, **mission** and **values**.

We will look at this subject in more detail in Module Four, but it is introduced here along with BUILD's own vision, mission and values.

1.5.1 BUILD's vision

A vision statement paints a picture of the future we hope to see as a result of the work we do in partnership with God and his people.

> "BUILD's vision is to see a multitude of well-equipped leaders at the grassroots building healthy churches across Africa's Great Lakes Region and beyond."

1.5.2 BUILD's mission

In addition to a vision, it is important to have a clear purpose. A mission statement captures how we aim to achieve our vision, as we work with God and his people.

> "BUILD's mission is to enable churches to train their own leaders with a practical understanding of the gospel, Scripture and theology."

1.5.3 BUILD's values

In addition to a vision and mission it is helpful for churches, organisations and projects to have a clear set of values. Values are the foundational principles we hold, which motivate and guide us.

BUILD has five values. They are convictions about Christian learning, which are rooted in the five words BUILD stands for.

1. Biblical – BUILD believes in <u>learning under Scripture</u>

The word 'biblical' (and "Scripture" in 2 Tim 3:16-17) reminds us that our learning must come under the authority of God's word. The Bible and its gospel must be central to our training if personal development and local church growth is to be genuine.

2. Understanding – BUILD believes in <u>learning with integrity</u>

The word 'understanding' (and "handle" in 2 Tim 2:15) reminds us that our learning must be conducted with integrity. Skilful and godly use of the Bible and its gospel are essential for the development and growth of true leaders.

3. In-service – BUILD believes in <u>learning in context</u>

The word 'in-service' (and "reflect" in 2 Tim 2:7) reminds us that learning is best done in the midst of ministry and mission. The training of local church leaders is to be done in partnership with their churches. BUILD was developed locally, which reflects this.

4. Leadership – BUILD believes in <u>learning and leadership</u>

The word 'leadership' (and "entrust" in 2 Tim 2:2) reminds us that leadership and learning belong together. Leaders who understand the gospel deeply and identify and invest in others are essential for healthy churches. This assumes teamwork and learning together.

5. Development – BUILD believes in <u>learning for life</u>

The word 'development' (and "continue" in 2 Tim 3:14) reminds us that while every training course comes to an end, Christian discipleship does not. Learning is for life and so our training must equip leaders to be life-long learners.

1.6 THE STRUCTURE OF A BUILD PROGRAMME

BUILD programmes look different in different places but they all have the same underlying structure. That structure is designed to help BUILD teams deliver training in partnership with churches. We will have a look at that structure now so that you can find out where you belong and how you can learn from and contribute to the programme.

In Module Four we will learn the importance of having clear goals to aim at when we are developing a training project, and of thinking through the activities that will help us to achieve those goals. Once we have described the activities we can identify the resources that are needed and create a schedule that we can follow.

BUILD's main goals and activities are embedded in the programme structure, so look closely for those.

1.6.1 The four-fold structure of BUILD

A BUILD programme has four key elements that work together to deliver training and to build healthy churches. Those key elements can be remembered through these words:

1. **FORCE**
2. **FOUNDATION**
3. **FOCUS**
4. **FRUIT**

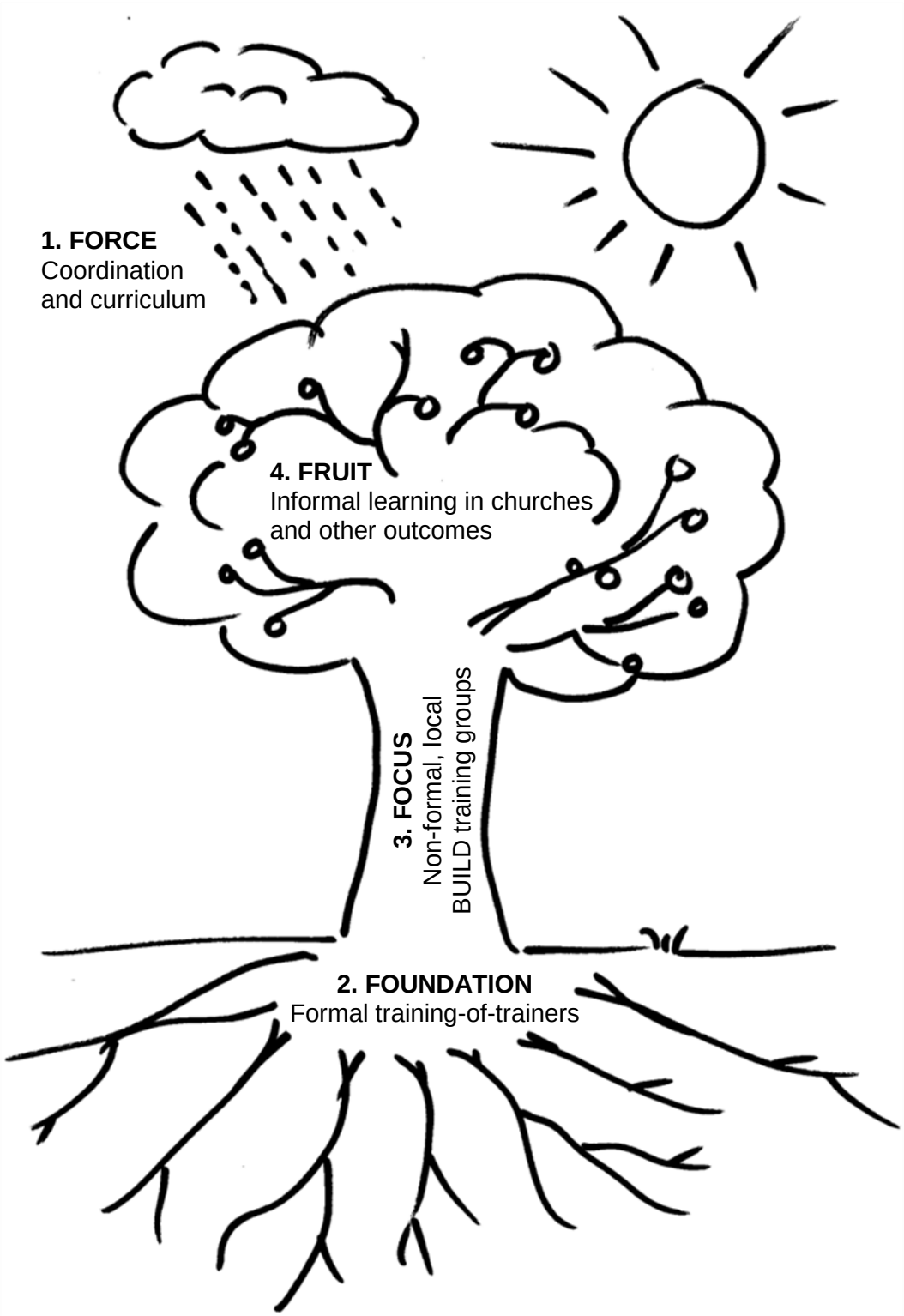
Unpacking that:

1. The **FORCE** behind BUILD is **coordination and curriculum**
2. The **FOUNDATION** of BUILD is the **formal training-of-trainers**
3. The **FOCUS** of BUILD is the **non-formal training of local church leaders**
4. The **FRUIT** of BUILD is **informal training in churches and other impacts**

Before explaining those four areas in more detail it is helpful to imagine a BUILD programme as a tree. A healthy tree, with deep roots, a strong trunk and shady branches full of fruit is a good way of thinking about the BUILD programme and its structure.

The one in the picture below might be a mango tree, which provides shade to talk and work in, and fruit for people to enjoy. Your Trainer will explain this picture to you.

1.6.2 A BUILD programme pictured as a healthy tree



1.6.3 A BUILD programme and its four components

Now you can see how the four parts of a BUILD programme fit together, you will begin to understand how a BUILD programme helps to grow God's church. A typical programme is described below.

1. The FORCE behind a BUILD programme is…

…its curriculum and coordination

Programme coordination and BUILD's own course are essential for the health of any BUILD programme. These ensure that it is well-managed and well-resourced.

The BUILD course or curriculum is the key resource BUILD puts into the hands of its trainers to help them to equip others. It continues to be developed and translated.

Coordinators, trainers and local trainers coordinate the work in various ways, but the coordinators lead this work of oversight.

2. The FOUNDATION of a BUILD programme is…

…the formal training-of-trainers

BUILD's formal training-of-trainers produces grassroots educators for the local BUILD groups: trainers who can use the BUILD course and its training materials to equip others.

This training-of-trainers is sometimes done in partnership with a college, a training centre, or a network of churches using a formal BUILD-based course.

These trainers begin to train participants in local BUILD groups during the course itself. In the process they are equipped for more effective ministry themselves, an additional benefit of the programme.

3. The FOCUS of a BUILD programme is…

…the non-formal training of local church leaders

Non-formal BUILD training is done in the setting of a local BUILD group. The participants are church leaders at the grassroots: BUILD's target group (mature Christians, lay workers and others who lead within local congregations).

These groups are led by BUILD trainers or local trainers (promising local participants who emerge and help strengthen and multiply these local groups).

This group based learning is at the heart of the programme. Groups follow the BUILD course and any recognition of this non-formal training takes place at the local level.

4. The FRUIT of a BUILD programme is…

…informal training and other impacts

Informal training through relationships is a direct outcome of BUILD, together with healthy local ministry. This includes more effective preaching, teaching and care.

Those who have participated in the non-formal training might use the BUILD materials or they might simply use their Bible-based learning and the principles of BUILD.

Outreach is improved as a result, and lives, churches and communities are transformed as the gospel is proclaimed more effectively through both word and deed.

Look back through the description and discuss it with the Trainer and others in the group. Make sure you understand how the programme works.

If you are a Participant or Local Trainer you are at the heart of the programme in element 3: The FOCUS of BUILD – Non-formal training of local church leaders.

1.7 INTRODUCING THE BUILD COURSE

A course or curriculum is a pathway for learning. It is a pathway that has been designed to take you from one place to the next. From your current set of attitudes, skills and knowledge to a new level, one that will help you to build your church.

1.7.1 The BUILD course has 10 modules or manuals

Module One	2 Timothy & the Pastoral Epistles: Preaching the Gospel & Godly Leadership
Module Two	Genesis & the Pentateuch: Knowing God's Story & Leading by Faith
Module Three	Mark & the Gospels: The Servant King & Servant Leadership
Module Four	Nehemiah & the Historical Books: Building God's People & Strategic Leadership
Module Five	Acts & the New Testament Story: The Mission of the Church & Missional Leadership
Module Six	Psalms & Poetry: Worshipping the King & Wholehearted Leadership
Module Seven	Ephesians & the Epistles: God's Plan for the Church & Local Church Leadership
Module Eight	Proverbs & Wisdom: The Fear of the Lord & Practical Leadership
Module Nine	Isaiah & the Prophets: The Sovereign King & Prophetic Leadership
Module Ten	Revelation & Apocalyptic: The Victorious Christ & Leaders that Endure

You have the first of these in your hands.

NOTE: Not all BUILD courses cover all modules.

1.7.2 Each module has four main components

The titles above show that each module has four main components:

1. **A Bible book** as the focus. (2 Timothy in the case of Module One.)

2. **A group of Bible books** the Bible book is linked to. (Module One takes The Pastoral Epistles – 1 and 2 Timothy and Titus). NOTE: In some cases it is a type of writing or theme rather than a group of books.

3. **A theological theme** that is central to the book and to church leadership. ('Preaching the Gospel' is the theme of Module One.)

4. **A leadership issue** that flows from the book, the books, and the theme. ('Godly Leadership' is the big issue for Module One.)

This gives the following summary for Module One:

Bible book	Group of books	Theological theme	Leadership issue
2 Timothy	The Pastoral Epistles	Preaching the Gospel	Godly Leadership

Unit 11 explains how and why the Bible books and groups of books are arranged in the curriculum in the way that they are.

1.7.3 Each module has fifteen learning units and they are of four types

There are fifteen learning units or lessons in each module. And each of those is one of the following four kinds of learning unit:

1. **Tools** for encountering God's word in God's world. These units give you the knowledge and the skills you need for handling the Bible.

2. **Encounters** with God's word in God's world. These units put the tools you have gained to work as you look at passages of Scripture. They will help you to discover the meaning of different passages and to teach them to others.

3. **Reflection** for wisdom. These units help you to think for yourself about different issues, and they equip you to lead others in that process. In other words these units will develop your skills of theological reflection.

4. **Action** as leaders in mission. These units provide practical training in a number of areas such as preaching, pastoral care and leadership, which are essential for local church leaders.

1.7.4 Contents of Module One and the BUILD curriculum as a whole

The four types of learning unit feature in the Contents page of Module One.

Turn back to that and take a look at the contents of the module.

Your Trainer can guide you through an overview of the 15 units so that you understand the links between them.

All 150 units of the BUILD curriculum can be found in the contents at the beginning and end of this module, so that you can see everything that is covered and how it all fits together.

1.8 CONCLUSION

1.8.1 The word 'BUILD' in the New Testament

We will end the unit in our Bibles. We have looked at Matthew 16:18. Spend time together discussing these two questions.

- Can you think of other verses in the New Testament where the word 'BUILD' or the idea of building is used when talking about the life of the church?

- What do these verses teach us and why is the word 'build' so important in the New Testament?

1.8.2 A commitment to learning

Don't worry if you haven't fully grasped all of this material. The rest of the module will build on this foundation. It will make more sense as we move through the training together. It took Jesus time to take his disciples and to build them into leaders.

- Make a commitment, together, to grow as leaders through committing to the BUILD programme, and close in prayer.

As you pray remember that important phrase and promise in the BUILD verse, "I will build my church" (Matt 16:18). Thank the Lord Jesus that he has promised to build his church, that he will nurture and protect it until it is firm and steadfast forever, and that he does so in partnership with us.